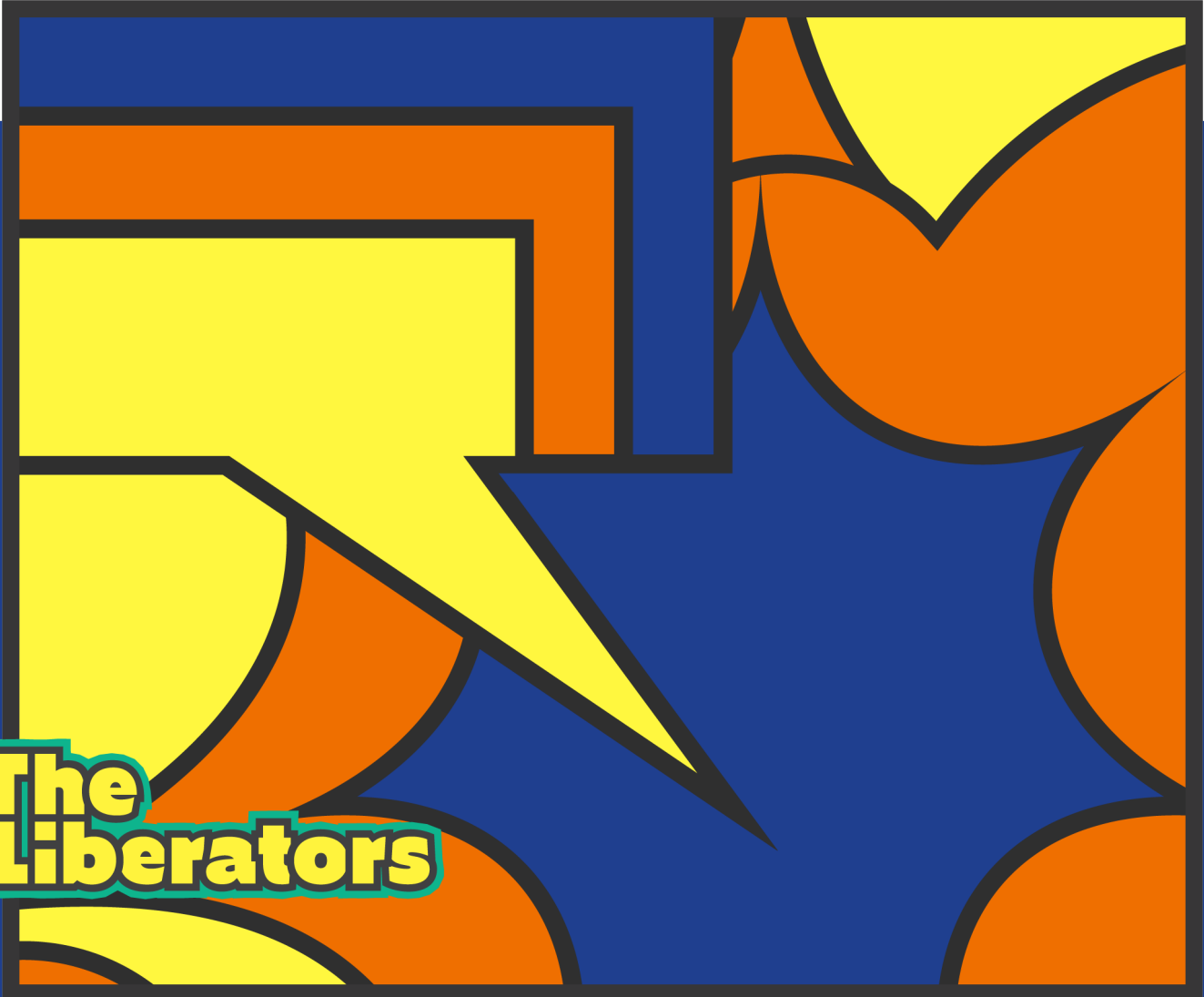


Clarify How To Deliver Value To Stakeholders With Purpose-To-Practice

Clarify why your product matters to your stakeholders and identify how your team should collaborate to deliver that effectively



**The
Liberators**

The Purpose Of This Workshop

Hey there!

The results of the survey show that the ability of your team to build what stakeholders need lies below the average of other teams. Your team may have trouble bringing stakeholders to Sprint Reviews. Or there is little to no collaboration with stakeholders. Or there is no singular Product Goal to guide development and clarify what is valuable. This is certainly a clear indicator of Zombie Scrum.



Created by These Solutions for the Zombie Scrum Survival Guide
by Christian Vande, Johannes Scharf & Barry Christiaan
zombiescrum.org

One of the causes of this is when people focus on

Scrum as a 'methodology' instead of the underlying purpose. It is easy to 'implement' Scrum by changing a few job titles, adding 'Scrum meetings' to an already overcrowded schedule, and hoping for the best.

While this mechanical view is understandable, it misses the entire purpose of the framework. The Scrum framework exists to reduce the risk of wrong assumptions about what stakeholders need. This includes what stakeholders assume their needs are in the first place. Scrum is all about addressing those needs in small steps, starting with the most important ones, and using each step to test both the need and the proposed solution. Obviously, you cannot do this without close collaboration with stakeholders (users and customers).

We designed this string to help you clarify why your product matters to your stakeholders and identify how your team should collaborate to deliver that effectively.

This string taps into the five core components: purpose, principles, participants, structure, and practices. We recommend that you revisit and update the P2P periodically. This string is designed for two hours. If you don't have that time, you can break it up into two sessions (e.g. purpose and principles in one, and the rest in the other).

Now of you go, give the string a try, and let us know how it went!

Barry & Christiaan

The Liberators

Flow



Step 1: Opening

 2 min

Step 2: Clarify Your Purpose With Nine Whys

  30 min

Step 3: Clarify Your Principles With Min Specs

  30 min

Step 4: Determine Whom You Need To Involve With 1-2-4-ALL

  15 min

Step 5: Consider Your Structure With 1-2-4-ALL

  15 min

Step 6: Identify Practices With 25/10 Crowd Sourcing

  15 min

Step 7: 15% Solutions

  10 min

Step 8: Closing

 3 min

Total duration

 120 min

Difficulty / Effort



Required Skill



If you're new to Liberating Structures, try basic structures to explore the 5 elements of Purpose-to-Practice.

Impact On Survival



A shared purpose, clear goals, and a structure to collaborate with stakeholders will definitely move you towards healthy Scrum.



How To Prepare



Group Size

This string of Liberating Structures is feasible from 4 participants and onward. We've successfully scaled it up to 100 participants (both virtually and in-person) without significant issues.

Intended Audience

You can run this string with pretty much any audience. Although the invitations and steps for this particular string are aimed at Scrum teams and their stakeholders. A small-scale workshop would be only with your Scrum team. A recommended large-scale workshop would include your stakeholders as well.

Virtual Delivery

Liberating Structures work well virtually. Here too, they allow you to unleash and involve everyone. What is exceptionally important, however, is that you have the right tools. Because Liberating Structures are fundamentally about breaking down large-group interactions into smaller groups, you need tools that allow you to create subchannels or breakout rooms easily. [Zoom](#) is ideal for this, but similar features are available in tools like [Teams](#) and [GotoMeeting](#). We also recommend a virtual whiteboard where you can collect shared insights, like [Mural](#), [Miro](#), or [Google Slides](#). Even [Slack](#) can work.

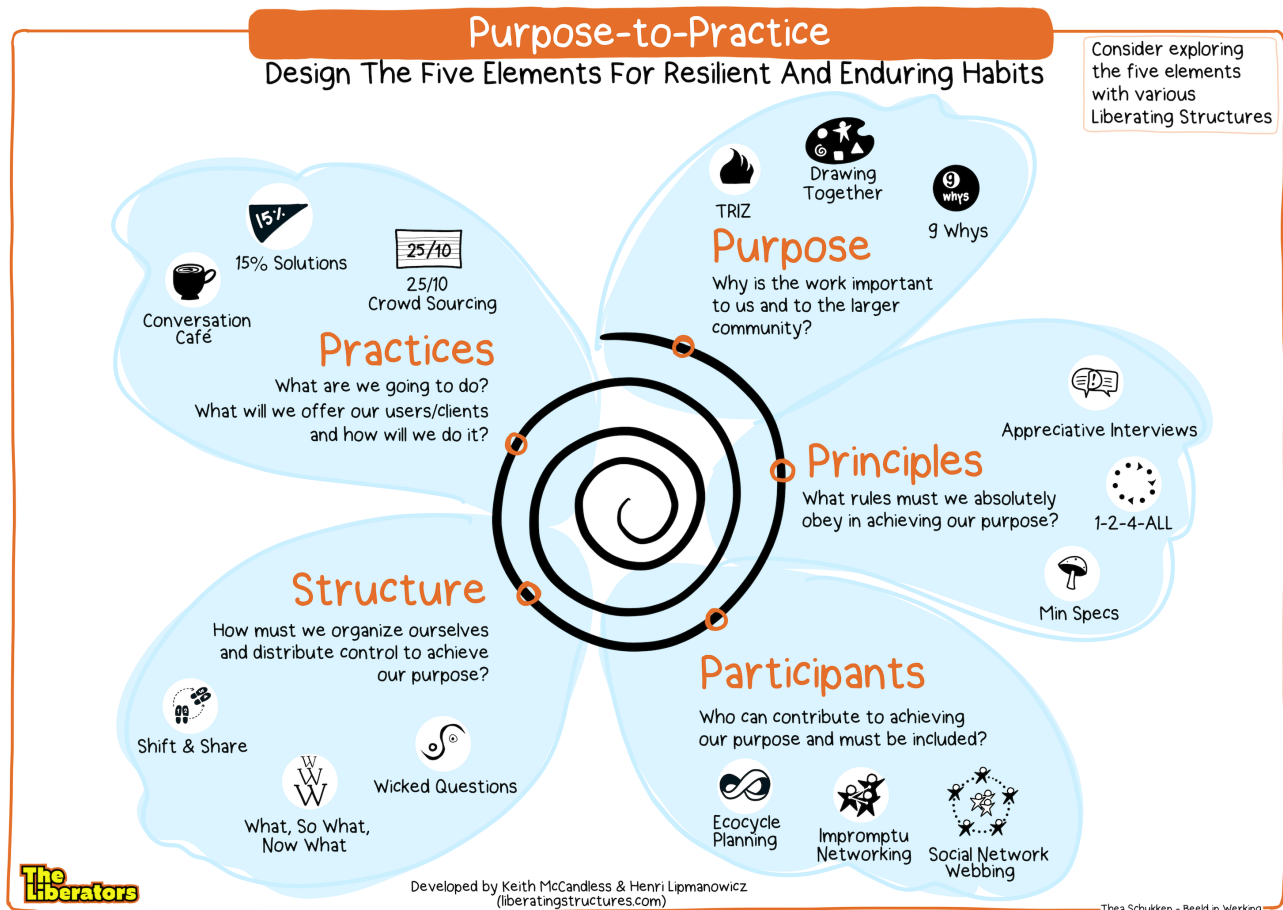
Material

- Optionally, [The Liberators Meetup Starter Kit](#) that patrons in the "Liberator"-tier receive for free
- Prepare basic slides or a virtual whiteboard to collect your insights. You can also [include this poster](#) about Purpose-to-Practice there.
- Register for the [free 25/10 Crowd Sourcing app](#) created by David Heath and create a "Challenge" there (see Step 6).
- An example of a Purpose-to-Practice can be found [here](#). This was created by the Dutch Liberating Structures User Group, and is occasionally updated.

Resources

- Blog post: [Shaping Resilient Initiatives With Purpose-to-Practice](#)
- [Purpose to Practice](#) on the Liberating Structures website
- Blog post: [Start a Liberating Structures User Group](#)
- Blog post: [Refresh the Purpose of the Scrum Framework](#)
- Blog post: [Actual stakeholders? Or just your audience?](#)





🕒 2 min

Step 1: Opening

Start at the scheduled time. People who drop in later can jump in then. We always start our gatherings by simply saying "Hi!", followed by our name. We then introduce the purpose and start with the first structure. Superfast!

We've learned that the best way to drain energy is to talk for a long time, to ask everyone to introduce themselves, or to wait for people to drop in.

Step 2: Clarify Your Purpose With Nine Whys

"[Start with Why](#)" is the title of a well-known book by Simon Sinek. It isn't any different for the product your Scrum team is building. Here too, it is important to start by answering the question of why it exists. If this purpose is appealing, people will enjoy being part of the team. The Liberating Structure [Nine Whys](#) is a great way to think about this with your team. It starts from the personal motivations and reasons and builds to the start of a shared purpose.

Invitation

"This product exists in order to "

Steps

1. **2 min** Individually, ask everyone to compile a list of the reasons, hopes, and aspirations that they have for the product the Scrum team is building.
2. Provide an overview of the steps that are coming up so that people know what to expect once they're in their breakouts.
3. **8 min** Invite everyone to form pairs and move them into separate breakouts. In there, people interview each other in turns (4 min each) about their list. Interviewers only ask "Why is that (item/entire list) important for you?" while taking notes.
4. **8 min** Invite pairs to join another pair in new breakouts. In there, the pairs exchange notes and notice patterns about why people are part of this Scrum team. In the final minutes, ask the groups to complete the sentence "This product exists in order to".
5. **5 min** Back in the main channel, each group briefly presents its purpose statement. Together, you can pick one that jumps out. Or just notice patterns across the statements.

Examples

- This meetup exists to put a stop to dehumanizing and ineffective ways of working in this organization
- This meetup exists to provide a space where Scrum practitioners can give and get help to overcome the tough impediments they face in their work
- This Scrum team exists in order to develop a new webshop so our stakeholders can sell their products online as well

Our Findings

- Groups can easily get stuck in the process of coming up with a great purpose statement. It is important to work empirically here, too. Start with a quick and raw version and improve it over time as you learn more about this meetup.
- A compelling purpose can never be fully achieved. A purpose can also be very strong when it is about stopping things (e.g. "this meetup exists in order to STOP...")

Resources

- The [original article](#) from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Make the Purpose of Your Work Together Clear with 'Nine Whys'](#)



Step 3: Clarify Your Principles With Min Specs



Now that you have some clarity on why your product matters to your stakeholders, the next step is to think about the rules and principles you must be followed in order to be, and remain, successful in that purpose.

In order to avoid long lists of rules, it is important to focus your Scrum team on the essential rules. The Liberating Structure [Min Specs](#) is a great structure for this. It invites people to first think as broadly as possible – encouraging all sorts of creative and outside-of-the-box ideas – and then funnels it back down to what is absolutely essential.

Invitation

"What are the essential rules we must absolutely follow in order to succeed in achieving our purpose?"

Steps

1. **2 min** Ask everyone to individually and silently generate a list of must-dos and must-not-dos.
2. **8 min** Invite people into small groups (3–5) and move them into separate breakouts. Together, they consolidate their lists and expand it to make it as long as possible (Max Specs).
3. **8 min** Bring everyone back to the main channel and explain the next step. Once they're back in their breakouts, ask the groups to test each of the items on their lists against the purpose statement. Let them ask: "Can we still be successful with this Scrum team if we broke this rule?". Each group removes all the items that aren't absolutely essential (Min Specs).
4. **8 min** When everyone is back in the main channel, collect the remaining rules on a shared workspace, removing duplicates and clarifying as needed.

Our Findings

- We often encourage teams to generate more rules for the "Max Specs"–part. This drives more creative and less-obvious rules that may end up being super important. At the same time, we always encourage teams to be more minimalistic during the "Min Specs"–round
- It is better to end with two, three, or maybe four clear rules that people will absolutely adhere to than to generate a list of a dozen abstract principles. If you find that people are getting stuck in abstract principles (e.g. "We have to work to understand each other"), ask them what behavior fits (or doesn't fit) with the principle (e.g. "We demonstrate active listening behaviors to each other" or "We don't criticize what people say").

Resources

- The [original article](#) for "Min Specs" from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Use 'Min Specs' to help groups discover what is absolutely essential](#)

Step 4: Determine Whom You Need To Involve With 1-2-4-ALL

Who else needs to be included in order to achieve your purpose? What stakeholders, customers, users, managers, or other teams need to be involved? The Liberating Structure [1-2-4-ALL](#) is a great way to quickly surface the most important participants to involve, invite, or acknowledge (when they're already present).

Invitation

"Who must be included to achieve our purpose?"

Steps

1. **1 min** Ask the Scrum team to first individually consider the most relevant participants or groups of participants, writing them down for themselves as needed.
2. **2 min** Divide your team into pairs and move them into breakouts. There, they quickly share their lists and add or remove participants.
3. **4 min** Create groups of four, preferably by keeping the pairs together and moving them into new breakouts. Ask the groups to share their lists and build on them.
4. **5 min** Together, collect all the participants on a shared workspace and remove duplicates as needed.

Our Findings

- As with all the steps in this string, don't fall into the temptation to create exhaustive lists. Whom do you need to involve right now? Who is most critical to your success? Start there and expand later.
- 1-2-4-ALL is purposefully quick. Even though people may individually struggle to generate much, the group as a whole will.

Resources

- The [original article](#) for "1-2-4-ALL" from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Engage Everyone Simultaneously in Generating Questions, Ideas, and Suggestions with 1-2-4-ALL](#)



Step 5: Consider Your Structure With 1-2-4-ALL

One of the tenets of Liberating Structures is that control is distributed, rather than in one person or a small group. How will you organize to distribute control while also remaining one Scrum team?

Invitation

"How will we distribute control instead of relying on top-down control?"

Steps

1. **1 min** Ask people to first individually consider how this Scrum team can distribute control.
2. **2 min** Invite people into pairs and move them into breakouts. There, they quickly share their ideas and build on them.
3. **4 min** Invite people into groups of four, preferably by keeping the pairs together and moving them into new breakouts. Ask the groups to share their ideas and build on them.
4. **5 min** Together, collect all the participants on a shared workspace and remove duplicates as needed.

Examples

Thinking about control, distribution and structure don't always come naturally to groups. Who controls what happens during each Scrum event? How do you collaborate in a way that allows everyone to contribute, rather than one or two people taking the lead all the time? For example:

- Each Scrum event is facilitated by another member of this group.
- Each Scrum event is prepared by mixing pairs that work together to both prepare and run the event.
- For virtual communication, the Scrum team agrees to use WhatsApp or Slack.

Our Findings

- This second use of 1-2-4-ALL is a good example of the Liberating Structure principle "a repetition is also a form of learning". By doing 1-2-4-ALL twice in a row, but with a different question, people start building the skill to run these structures on their own – without facilitation.



Step 6: Identify Practices With 25/10 Crowd Sourcing

Now that you have more clarity on the purpose, the principles, and the practices it is important to consider what it is that you will be doing together; *the practices*. The Liberating Structure [25/10 Crowd Sourcing](#) offers a good way to rapidly capture such ideas and build commitment from people.

Invitation

"What is a topic or practice that is relevant to our purpose and that you'd like to dig deeper into?"

Steps

1. Share the link to the 25/10 Crowd Sourcing challenge that you prepared earlier in the [free online app](#).
2. **2 min** Individually, ask everyone to silently submit one big idea they have for this Scrum team.
3. **8 min** Explain the next steps. In a moment, you will be starting the voting session. Ask people to rate each idea on a scale of 1 to 5, 1 meaning "Meh. I wouldn't commit to joining this session" and 5 meaning "Love it! If this session is hosted, I commit to being there". Start the voting session in the app and move to the next round when people have voted. Repeat five times.
4. **5 min** Conclude the voting and share the link with results from the app with everyone. Briefly collect the top 5 ideas. There's no need to dig deeper into them now.

Our findings

- 25/10 Crowd Sourcing is purposefully anonymous to give everyone an equal voice. Resist the temptation to ask who suggested an idea (regardless of its score).
- The 25/10 Crowd Sourcing was built by David Heath. David is a friend and an active member of the global Liberating Structures community. [Buy him a coffee](#) if you like it.

Resources

- The [original article](#) for "1-2-4-ALL" from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Engage Everyone Simultaneously in Generating Questions, Ideas, and Suggestions with 1-2-4-ALL](#)

Step 7: 15% Solutions

We like to end sessions on a personal note by asking people what it is that they want to contribute to the success of this meetup. A good start is the top 5 ideas that originated from the 25/10 Crowd Sourcing. No matter how small, if everyone makes one small change, together this generates large change. The Liberating Structure [15% Solutions](#) is super useful for this.

Invitation

"What is your personal 15% Solution to contribute to the success of this Scrum team? What is something you can do that you do without permission from other or resources you don't have access to?"

Steps

1. **3 min** Ask everyone to silently generate a list of personal 15% Solutions.
2. **5 min** Form pairs and invite each pair into their own breakouts. In the breakouts, people take turns to share their 15% Solutions. We always encourage listeners to help their partners find ways to guarantee that they will actually do those things (e.g. make it smaller, simpler).

Our Findings

- It is tempting for people to complicate their 15% Solutions, which makes it unlikely they'll actually do them. You can encourage people by asking them "What is the thing you're going to do to work on that [original idea]?"
- You can make individual 15% Solutions transparent on your virtual whiteboard. But make sure that this is optional.

Resources

- The original article on [15% Solutions](#) on the Liberating Structures website
- Blog post: Trigger BIG change by starting small with ["15% Solutions"](#)

Step 8: Closing

If you have the time, do a quick debrief with the group. A simple Liberating Structure for this is [Impromptu Networking](#) ("What did you observe, think or feel while participating in this meetup?"). Draw out some salient patterns from the whole group, but keep it short.

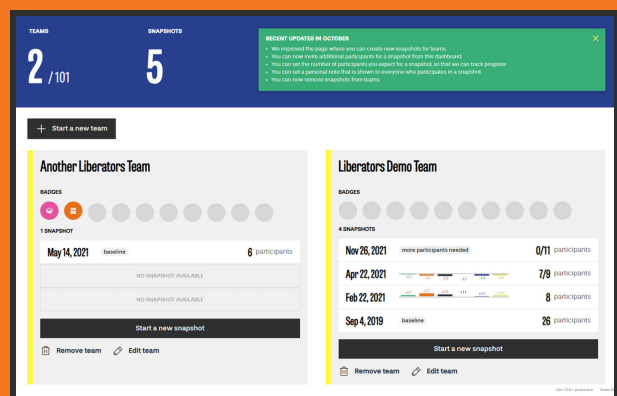
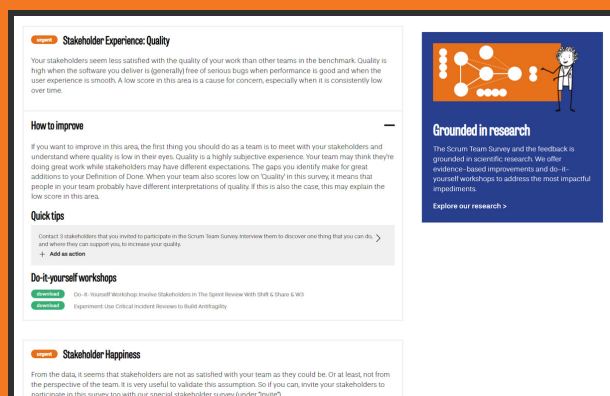
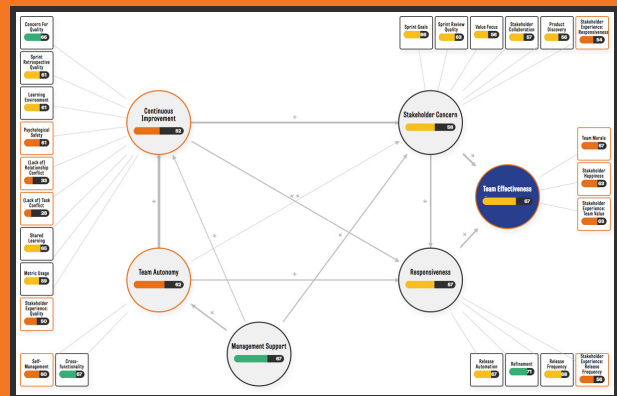
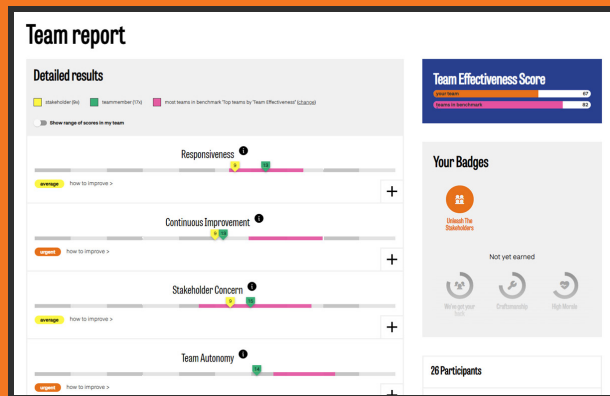
If you've got any questions, comments, or ideas: always feel free to reach out and share them with us.

Let's learn and grow, together!



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Want to make your Scrum team more effective? We created the Scrum Team Survey to help. Invite members and stakeholders to a detailed questionnaire and diagnose the results together. You receive tons of actionable feedback based on your results, including dozens of quick tips and useful do-it-yourself workshops. You can use the Scrum Team Survey for free with your team. No account or e-mail address is required. You can also subscribe for more advanced features.



	Essential	Liberator
Invite team members & stakeholders	unlimited	unlimited
Quick Tips for your team per topic	3	unlimited
Recommendations to your team	5	unlimited
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info@scrumteamsurvey.org

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